

GRIDALIGN

Coordination Opportunity Report

Georgia Power

Plant McIntosh Upgrades

Distance between closest known points: 24.74 km

Dominion Energy South Carolina

Okatie - McIntosh 115kV Tie: Add Series Reactor

PROJECTS

- Plant McIntosh Upgrades: A natural gas power plant upgrade project located in Rincon, Effingham County, Georgia, adding 268 MW of capacity, associated with Georgia Power regulatory filings.
- Okatie - McIntosh 115kV Tie: Add Series Reactor: A substation and equipment project in Okatie, Beaufort County, South Carolina, to construct Deerfield Switching Station and install a series reactor; the specific utility company is not stated in the provided data.

WHY GRIDALIGN FLAGGED THIS PAIR

- The projects are 24.74 km apart at their closest known points, placing them in the under 40 km distance tier.
- Project B involves the Okatie - McIntosh 115kV Tie Line, indicating a direct regional electrical connection to the Plant McIntosh vicinity.

GEOGRAPHIC ANALYSIS

- At 24.74 km apart, the sites are close enough to support shared regional construction planning.
- This distance may allow project teams to coordinate mobilization of regional specialized contractors, high-voltage crews, and specialized equipment between coastal South Carolina and eastern Georgia.

TIMELINE ANALYSIS

- Project B has a planned completion date of December 31, 2028, with no start date provided.
- Project A is listed as approved, but both start and end dates are unrecorded.
- Timeline compatibility cannot be fully confirmed due to missing schedule milestones for both projects.

COORDINATION OPPORTUNITIES

- Outage timing and grid operational planning, as Project B modifies a tie line linking Okatie to McIntosh.
- Shared specialized contractors for high-voltage electrical installations, testing, and commissioning, if schedules align.

- Shared heavy-duty equipment, such as large cranes or specialized transport haulers, if required at both locations.
- Regional construction sequencing to prevent simultaneous transmission constraints or access bottlenecks.

POTENTIAL BENEFITS

- May reduce duplicate mobilization and demobilization expenses for heavy equipment and specialized labor.
- Could improve regional grid reliability by coordinating system outages required for tie-line and plant work.
- Promotes cross-border transmission and generation planning efficiency.

RISKS AND LIMITATIONS

- Incomplete schedule data for Project A prevents confirmation of overlapping construction windows.
- Different core scopes of work, with one project focusing on power plant expansion and the other on substation switching and line reactors.
- Projects are situated in different states (Georgia and South Carolina), which may involve different utilities, labor agreements, and regulatory jurisdictions.

FINAL ASSESSMENT

MEDIUM

Meaningful coordination appears plausible because the projects are located 24.74 km apart and Project B involves the tie line connecting directly to McIntosh. However, important uncertainty remains regarding Project A's schedule and the coordinating operating companies.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Transmission planners from both utilities should hold an initial joint coordination meeting to determine Project A's construction schedule and review potential outage constraints on the Okatie - McIntosh 115kV Tie Line.